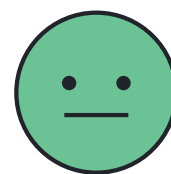
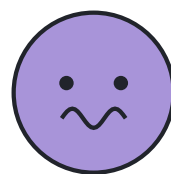
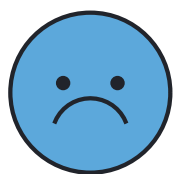


TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Scroll Smart

Social Media, Mood & Mental Health - A Workbook for Teens

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

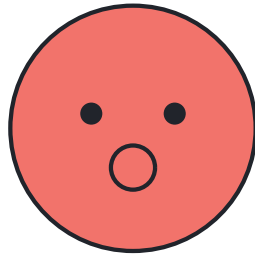
- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 How Social Media Affects Mood
- 2 My Digital Habits
- 3 Comparison & Self-Worth
- 4 Healthier Online Habits
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: How Social Media Affects Mood

The apps are designed to keep you scrolling.



Why It's So Hard to Put Down

Social apps are engineered to hold your attention. Likes, streaks, and endless feeds give little hits of dopamine that keep you coming back - it's not a lack of willpower, it's design. Knowing that puts you back in charge.

Social media isn't all bad: it connects us, informs us, and can be creative and fun. The goal isn't to quit forever - it's to use it on purpose instead of on autopilot, and to notice how it affects your mood.

Signs it's hurting more than helping

- ☐ You feel worse about yourself after scrolling.
- ☐ You lose track of time or lose sleep.
- ☐ You compare your life to everyone's highlight reel.
- ☐ You feel anxious when you can't check it.



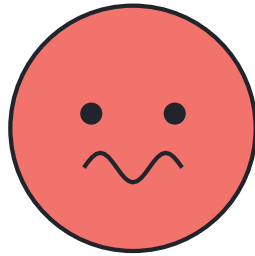
The Highlight Reel Trap

People mostly post their best moments - the wins, the good angles, the fun. Comparing your behind-the-scenes to someone else's highlight reel is a rigged game you can't win.

What you see is curated, filtered, and often staged. Remembering that protects your mood when the comparison monster shows up.

Reality check

- ☐ A post is a chosen moment, not a whole life.
- ☐ Filters and edits are everywhere.
- ☐ Everyone has struggles they don't post.



Part 2: My Digital Habits

Notice your patterns without judgment.



My Social Media Check-In

Rate how true each has been lately.

1 = Rarely 5 = Very often

I check my phone first thing and last thing daily.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I feel worse about myself after scrolling.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I lose more time online than I meant to.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I compare myself to people I follow.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I feel anxious without my phone.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Screen time cuts into my sleep.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

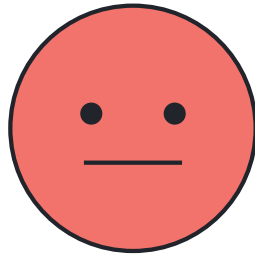
What my answers tell me



Mood vs. Screen-Time Tracker

Tracking your mood helps you spot patterns - what lifts you up and what drains you. Each day, shade your mood level (1 low - 5 high) and note one thing that affected it.

	1	2	3	4	5	What affected it?
Mon	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Tue	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Wed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Thu	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Fri	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Sat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Sun	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	



Part 3: Comparison & Self-Worth

Your worth isn't a number of likes.



Common Thinking Traps

Everyone's brain falls into 'thinking traps' sometimes. Naming them helps you step back. Circle the ones you notice most, then write an example.

All-or-nothing

Seeing things as total success or total failure, no middle ground.

Catastrophizing

Assuming the worst possible outcome will happen.

Mind-reading

Believing you know others are judging you - without proof.

Labeling

Calling yourself 'stupid' or 'a failure' over one event.

A thinking trap I fall into, and a real example:

Filtering

Only noticing the negatives and ignoring the positives.

Should statements

Harsh rules like 'I should always...' that set you up to feel bad.



Reframing Comparison Thoughts

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

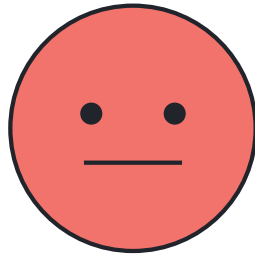
6. How I feel now:

Who Am I Offline?



List things about you that no post could capture.

When do you feel most like yourself - and is a screen involved?



Part 4: Healthier Online Habits

Use it on purpose.



Design Your Digital Boundaries

Small boundaries make a big difference. Tick the ones you'll try, then write your own.

- ☐ No phone for the first/last 30 minutes of the day.
- ☐ Turn off non-essential notifications.
- ☐ Unfollow accounts that make me feel worse.
- ☐ Phone out of the bedroom at night.
- ☐ Set a daily time limit on my heaviest app.
- ☐ Follow accounts that inspire or teach me.

My two digital boundaries this week



Things to Do Instead of Scrolling

When you catch yourself reaching for the phone out of boredom or stress, try one of these.

Fast resets (under 2 minutes)

- ☐ Slow breathing: in for 4, out for 6, a few rounds.
- ☐ Cold water on your face or hands.
- ☐ Name 5 things you see, 4 you hear, 3 you can touch.
- ☐ Unclench your jaw, drop your shoulders, shake out your hands.

Move & release

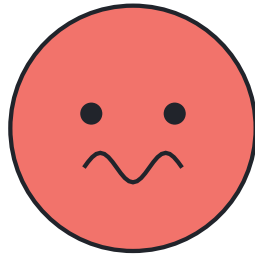
- ☐ Walk, stretch, or do a few push-ups or jumping jacks.
- ☐ Put on a song and move to it.
- ☐ Squeeze and release your muscles from head to toe.

Connect & express

- ☐ Text or talk to someone you trust.
- ☐ Write or draw what you're feeling - no filter.
- ☐ Do something kind for someone else.

Longer-term care

- ☐ Keep a steady sleep routine.
- ☐ Limit doom-scrolling before bed.
- ☐ Spend time on something that gives you meaning.



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Handle the tricky online moments.



Online Situations (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You see friends hanging out without you in a post.

What could you do?

2 A photo of you gets posted that you don't like.

What could you do?

3 You feel down comparing yourself to an influencer.

What could you do?



Online Situations (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 Someone leaves a mean comment or DM.

What could you do?

2 You keep checking for likes and feel let down.

What could you do?

3 A group chat gets heated or exclusionary.

What could you do?

My Scroll-Smart Plan



Make your plan for a healthier relationship with your phone.

Times/places I'll keep phone-free:

Accounts I'll unfollow or mute:

What I'll do when comparison hits:

One offline thing I want more of:

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Checking In With Myself

What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

My Notes & Reflections



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, alternating between light gray and white background colors.



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A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, spanning the width of the page below the header.



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A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

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Lined area for notes and reflections, consisting of 20 horizontal lines.



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